

Legacy changes need proof, not confidence.

A zero-key behavior-contract gate for one audited Python service. ShadowSpec rejects a plausible over-broad patch, accepts the narrow patch, and exports the evidence behind both verdicts.

THE MAINTENANCE REQUEST

Accept surrounding whitespace in SAVE10 while preserving case sensitivity, pricing, errors, and the SQLite audit write.

WHY THE BAD PATCH FAILS

```
code.strip().upper() == "SAVE10"
```

Whitespace passes, but lowercase save10 now receives a discount. Characterization fails, so ShadowSpec rejects it.

WHY THE NARROW PATCH PASSES

```
code.strip() == "SAVE10"
```

The requested case passes and every named preserved observation remains green. The verdict stays scoped to those fixtures.

EVIDENCE FLOW

1 AST map

2 Behavior contract

3 Candidate validation

4 Reviewer evidence

BOB WORKFLOW

Mapper to characterization designer to implementer to critic to release reviewer. The critic receives the full diff and context packet, not the implementer's success summary.

HOSTED SAFETY BOUNDARY

Bundled fixture execution only. No uploaded-code execution or dependency installation. Canonical path checks include symlinks. Runs use a temporary directory, timeout, bounded output, and no explicitly passed secrets. These controls are not an OS-level sandbox.

REVIEW OUTPUT Source hash, changed files, intended delta, preserved behavior, risks, reviewer checklist, rollback notes, and raw normalized results.

Scope: named fixtures and observed behavior. No semantic-equivalence or arbitrary-repository claim.